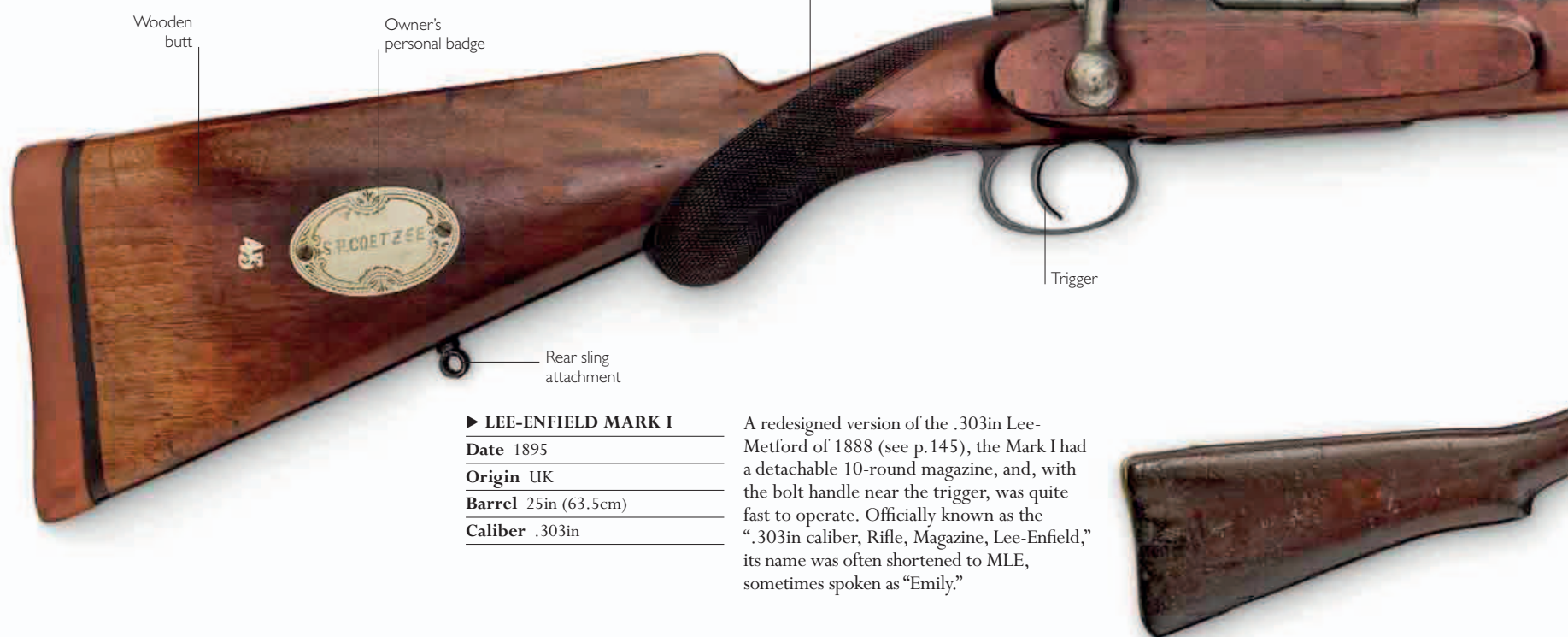


MANUALLY OPERATED REPEATING RIFLES (1894–95)

Rifle designers constantly sought greater performance, accuracy, and durability, and continued to experiment with designs for breech mechanisms and magazines. Steyr Mannlicher (see pp.290–91), for example, designed a successful mechanism that required the handle only to be pulled directly backward in order to revolve and unlock the bolt. Meanwhile, in lever-action rifles, Winchester (see pp.116–17) developed a complex mechanism in which a box magazine descended with the under-lever.



► LEE-ENFIELD MARK I

Date 1895

Origin UK

Barrel 25in (63.5cm)

Caliber .303in

A redesigned version of the .303in Lee-
Metford of 1888 (see p.145), the Mark I had
a detachable 10-round magazine, and, with
the bolt handle near the trigger, was quite
fast to operate. Officially known as the
“.303in caliber, Rifle, Magazine, Lee-Enfield,”
its name was often shortened to MLE,
sometimes spoken as “Emily.”